

WEST BENGAL **Joint Effort**



**MUKHERJEE
(LEFT) WITH
MAMATA
BANERJEE**

The Congress took the olive branch offered by Mamata Banerjee in West Bengal when it agreed to contest 14 Lok Sabha seats in the state. The Trinamool Congress will contest 28 seats. The alliance had seen rough weather over the last few weeks with the Congress saying that though they were open to the alliance, they should not be "insulted". Trinamool chief Banerjee had refused to talk shop with Congress leaders of the state. Banerjee will lead the fight against the Left Front. The Left is still optimistic. Says CPI(M)'s Subhas Chakraborty, "Though the alliance may dent the Left's vote share, we will certainly get 28 seats."

by Abhijit Dasgupta

Prize Catch



**SHAILESHRAVAL
JADEJA**

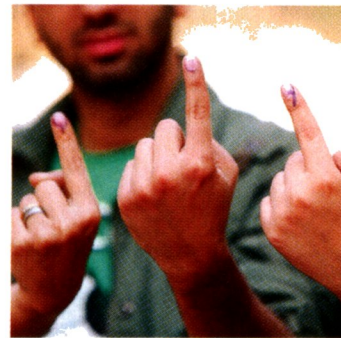
For the BJP, it was a prize catch even in a state where the Opposition is a distant second. Mandhatsinh Jadeja, 44, is the prince of the erstwhile state of Rajkot, but more importantly, son of senior Congress leader Manoharsinhji Jadeja. The BJP is counting on his fluent oratory skills in Gujarati, Hindi and English to consolidate its Rajput votes without adversely affecting its Patel votebank. Apparently, it was Chief Minister Narendra Modi's "good work in Gujarat" that inspired Jadeja to contest on a BJP ticket.

by Uday Mahurkar

INDIA INK

For Mysore Paints and Varnish Ltd, election is big business. The country's only public sector unit that makes indelible ink will supply 20 lakh bottles of the liquid for E-2009. Each 10 ml bottle inks 700 fingers. Its demand

HEMANT CHAWLA



is the highest in India's most populous state Uttar Pradesh, which needs 2.86 lakh bottles while Lakshwadeep requires just 120 bottles. The company's turnover was Rs 11 crore last year. It has exported indelible ink to Mongolia, Cambodia, the Maldives and Nepal. With nearly 60 countries going to polls this year, it hopes to make a killing.

by Stephen David